

WORQ: Closing the Gap

How the work order request process got faster, without changing who's in charge of the money.

BMO and JLL MTS technicians request work through a shared system called WORQ, emailed to crewos@bmo.com. The process that handled those requests had a real problem: every single request, no matter how small, had to wait for a live conversation with the Facility Manager before any work could happen. This project replaces that bottleneck with a structured intake process that gets small jobs moving right away, gives FMs everything they need to decide quickly on everything else, and lays out a clear path to close the loop with Corrigo, the work order system of record. Nothing about the FM's authority or the company's financial accountability changes. What disappears is the waiting.

Where We Started

The original procedure was a strict four-step gate. JLL MTS would issue a WORQ identifying the area of concern. The Facility Manager would be consulted to determine whether the request might qualify as Unplanned Capital. The FM would then review and validate labor and material costs. And until all of that was done, the rule was absolute:

“DO NOT PROCEED.”

That wasn't a loose guideline — it was written into the process itself, which stated plainly:

“All WORQ requests must be reviewed with the Facility Manager prior to authorization or execution.”

No exceptions for size or urgency. A forty-dollar part and a major system failure went through the exact same live-consultation gate. That's a real gap, not just red tape: it slowed down obviously routine work, pulled FMs into a conversation for every single request, and relied entirely on a verbal or written description, with no photos and no consistent structure — which made it easy for details to get lost between the tech and the FM.

What We Changed

The fix keeps the original goal — the FM's authority over cost and funding, and clean financial tracking — and removes the part that was just waiting.

- **A clear dollar line: \$499.** Routine jobs at or under that amount go straight through. Only requests that actually need a decision reach the FM for review.
- **Every category, captured every time.** Location, FM, priority, description, cost, vendor, asset, condition, remaining life, and capital type — the same complete set on every request, instead of a conversation that might only cover half of it. This is the headline improvement: nothing is ever missing, because the form won't let it be.
- **The request can't be sent incomplete.** The tech can only copy or send the email once the location, the FM, and a description are actually filled in — the tool enforces completeness instead of hoping for it.
- **Photos, captioned by the tech.** The FM sees the actual problem instead of just reading about it, and each photo can be downloaded with its caption burned directly into the image.
- **Techs recommend, FMs decide — made explicit.** Vendor choice, repair-vs-replace, and capital classification are labeled clearly as the tech's recommendation. The FM still confirms all of it; this just records that fact instead of requiring a live check-in to establish it.
- **A proposed one-click path for the easy cases.** For a plain internal repair with no vendor and no capital-vs-operating judgment call, approving it could also create the Corrigo work order directly, with no re-typing. Anything involving a vendor or a capital decision still comes to the FM as a manual call.

What Exists Today

There are two real, working pieces and one visual concept. **WORQ Intake** is a live web form technicians use instead of composing the WORQ email from memory — it walks through the same fields as the template, hides anything that doesn't apply, handles photo capture and captioning, and won't let a tech send a request until the required fields are filled in. It's live now at solmasta.github.io/WORQ. The **FM Review Queue** is a visual concept, not yet built: it shows what the FM's side could look like — a queue of incoming requests with approve, deny, or forward-to-leadership options, and one-click Corrigo creation proposed for the simple cases. There's also a detailed before-and-after comparison document covering the same ground in more depth.

What Stays Exactly the Same

This is worth saying plainly, because it's what makes the change safe rather than risky:

- The FM still has final say on funding, vendor choice, and whether something is repair, unplanned capital, or future capital.
- Nothing gets spent past the approved amount without the FM's OK — that hard stop is exactly as strict as it was before.
- Every job is still tracked and classified before it's closed out, for the budget and for the capital plan.

What's Next

This isn't finished, and it's worth being honest about what's still open. Embedding the tech tool's link inside Corrigo is a decision for whoever administers Corrigo. Real one-click work order creation needs OAuth API credentials from the Corrigo admin — until then, the one-click idea is a proposal, not a built feature. Notifying a tech of a decision should go through Corrigo's own Alerts and Notifications system, rather than building a separate one — one place for a tech to check, not two. And Smartsheet is a live alternative worth naming, since the company already uses it: its Forms, Approval Automations, and Dashboards could cover much of the intake, approval, and tally-reporting pieces natively, with honest trade-offs documented separately.

The accountability the original process was built to protect stays intact.

What disappears is the waiting.